01 The project at a glance

One shared source of truth. Complete at kickoff and update as the sprint evolves.

01 / CLIENT RECORD

Business & contacts

BUSINESS / TRADING NAME

[Legal name / public-facing name]

WEBSITE / LOCATION / SECTOR

[URL] / [Location] / [Industry]

PRIMARY CONTACT

[Name / role / email / phone]

STAKEHOLDERS & CONTRIBUTORS

[Names / roles / responsibilities]

APPROVAL OWNER

[One accountable decision-maker / email]

[Preferred communication channel / meeting cadence]

02 / PROJECT PLAN

Goals, scope & timing

PRIMARY GOAL

[What should this sprint change?]

SCOPE / EXCLUSIONS

[Included work] / [Not included]

DELIVERABLES / FORMATS

[Asset list / file formats / channels]

KICKOFF

[Date]

HANDOFF

[Date]

REVIEW MILESTONES

[Brief] → [Direction] → [Guidelines] / [Dates]

[Dependencies / budget reference / project constraints]

03 / WORKSPACE

Links & readiness

USEFUL LINKS

[Project folder / asset library]

[Research / existing brand material]

[Contract / scope of work]

HANDOFF CHECKLIST / MARK WHEN DONE

- ☐ Brief signed off
- ☐ Direction decision recorded
- ☐ Asset rights confirmed
- ☐ Brand book reviewed
- ☐ Final files shared / access checked

OPEN ITEMS / COMMENTS

[Question / owner / next step]

01 Business & challenge

Client intake / creative brief — begin with the business, not the visual solution.

01 / BUSINESS CONTEXT

What do you do, and why?

Describe your offer, business model and the value you create.

[Business / offer / reason to exist]

02 / THE CHALLENGE

What needs to change?

What is not working today? Why is now the right moment?

[Current challenge / trigger for the sprint]

03 / AMBITION

Where are you heading?

What should be different for the business in the next 12–24 months?

[Future ambition / priority goals]

04 / EXISTING EQUITY

What must we build on?

What is valued today? What should be kept, questioned or left behind?

[Keep] / [Question] / [Change]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Workshop notes

Record assumptions, missing context and questions for the client.

[Add notes / comments]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Agreed challenge / research needed]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

02 Audience & insight

Be specific about the people, the moment and the need the brand should serve.

01 / PRIORITY AUDIENCE

Who matters most?

Name the primary audience. Include context and behavior, not just demographics.

[Primary audience / secondary audience]

02 / NEED & MOTIVATION

What are they trying to do?

What practical need, emotional desire or job brings them to you?

[Need / motivation / desired outcome]

03 / BARRIERS & TRIGGERS

What moves or stops them?

What creates doubt? What triggers a choice? Where do they meet the brand?

[Barrier] / [Trigger] / [Touchpoint]

04 / EVIDENCE & INSIGHT

What do we know is true?

Add a customer quote or research finding. Separate evidence from assumptions.

[Insight / source / evidence still needed]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Workshop notes

Capture client comments and hypotheses to validate with real people.

[Add notes / comments]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Priority audience / validation action]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

03 Positioning & competition

Define the alternatives, the difference and the reason people should believe you.

01 / COMPETITIVE SET

What are the alternatives?

List direct competitors and the other ways people solve the same problem.

[Competitor / URL / strength / weakness]

02 / MEANINGFUL DIFFERENCE

Why choose this business?

What can you offer or own that is relevant, distinct and defensible?

[Difference / audience value]

03 / REASONS TO BELIEVE

What makes the promise credible?

Identify capabilities, facts, experiences or proof that support the difference.

[Claim / evidence / source]

04 / POSITIONING DRAFT

What space should we own?

For [audience], we are [category] that delivers [benefit] because [proof].

[Working positioning statement]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Workshop notes

Note overlaps, unsupported claims and opportunities to explore.

[Add notes / comments]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Positioning to test / evidence to collect]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

04 Personality & voice

Describe how the brand behaves and sounds, with boundaries that make it useful.

01 / CHARACTER

If the brand were a person...

Choose three traits. Describe what each looks like in action.

[Trait / behavior] × 3

02 / BOUNDARIES

We are this, not that.

Make the traits precise. Where does the personality stop?

[We are...] / [We are not...]

03 / VOICE & TONE

How should we sound?

Describe the voice, words to use or avoid, and how tone changes by context.

[Voice principles / tone by situation]

04 / MESSAGES IN PRACTICE

What would we actually say?

Draft a short introduction, headline or customer reply. Add a contrasting non-example.

[On-brand draft] / [Not our voice]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Workshop notes

Collect client reactions and language worth carrying forward.

[Add notes / comments]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Traits / voice principles to develop]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

05 Creative direction & requirements

Turn strategy into a useful creative starting point, with clear constraints.

01 / DESIRED IMPRESSION

What should people feel?

Name the first impression, associations and emotions the identity should create.

[Desired impression / keywords]

02 / REFERENCES

What inspires us — and why?

Link visual or verbal references. Note the principle to borrow, not a style to copy.

[Reference / link / what resonates]

03 / REQUIREMENTS

What must the system support?

List channels, languages, accessibility needs, formats and technical constraints.

[Requirement / context / priority]

04 / GUARDRAILS

What is fixed or off-limits?

Identify retained assets, legal needs, mandatory content and visual no-go areas.

[Must keep] / [Must avoid] / [Rights or approvals]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Workshop notes

Record non-negotiables and requests that need clarification before design.

[Add notes / comments]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Creative priorities / unresolved requirement]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

06 Success, scope & sign-off

Agree how the work will be judged, what will be delivered and who makes the call.

01 / SUCCESS CRITERIA

How will we know it works?

Connect each business goal to a measurable or observable outcome.

[Goal / measure / target / when]

02 / SCOPE AGREEMENT

What is included?

Confirm outputs, formats, rounds of revision and explicit exclusions.

[Deliverable / format / quantity / exclusions]

03 / PLAN & DEPENDENCIES

What happens, and when?

Record milestones, client inputs and the impact of delayed feedback.

[Milestone / date / dependency / owner]

04 / APPROVAL PROCESS

Who decides, and how?

Confirm the final approver, review group and feedback channel.

[Approver / reviewers / review window]

APPROVAL RECORD

Ready to proceed?

- ☐ Goals & criteria aligned
- ☐ Scope & schedule agreed
- ☐ Open questions resolved

CLIENT COMMENTS / CONDITIONS

[Requested changes before approval]

APPROVAL STATUS

[Pending / changes / approved]

APPROVAL OWNER / DATE

[Name / signature or approval link / date]

01 Direction A

[Direction name] — a visual hypothesis to explore, not an approved identity.

REFERENCE / HERO

+

[Anchor image]

[Source / what to borrow]

REFERENCE / DETAIL

+

[Material / texture]

[Source / file link]

REFERENCE / CONTEXT

+

[Composition / atmosphere]

[Source / file link]

DIRECTION RATIONALE

Why this route?

[Connect these references to the audience and strategic idea]

CLIENT FEEDBACK

[Resonates / concerns / changes]

PALETTE STUDY / NOT FINAL VALUES

[01] [02] [03] [04]

[Color references / temperature / contrast]

TYPOGRAPHY REFERENCE

[Typeface / specimen]

[Family / source / intended character]

Keywords: [Word] / [Word] / [Word]

DECISION / [DATE]

☐ Explore ☐ Refine ☐ Park

[Chosen elements / next step]

[Decision owner]

02 Direction B

[Direction name] — a visual hypothesis to explore, not an approved identity.

REFERENCE / DETAIL

+

[Form / gesture]

[Source / file link]

REFERENCE / TEXTURE

+

[Texture / finish]

[Source / file link]

REFERENCE / HERO

+

[Anchor image]

[Source / what to borrow]

DIRECTION RATIONALE

Why this route?

[Connect these references to the audience and strategic idea]

CLIENT FEEDBACK

[Resonates / concerns / changes]

PALETTE STUDY / NOT FINAL VALUES

[01] [02] [03] [04]

[Color references / temperature / contrast]

TYPOGRAPHY REFERENCE

[Typeface / specimen]

[Family / source / intended character]

Keywords: [Word] / [Word] / [Word]

DECISION / [DATE]

☐ Explore ☐ Refine ☐ Park

[Chosen elements / next step]

[Decision owner]

03 Direction C

[Direction name] — a visual hypothesis to explore, not an approved identity.

REFERENCE / VISUAL WORLD

+

[Anchor image]

[Source / file link]

REFERENCE / VISUAL CONTRAST

+

[Supporting image]

[Source / file link]

DIRECTION RATIONALE

Why this route?

[Connect these references to the audience and strategic idea]

CLIENT FEEDBACK

[Resonates / concerns / changes]

PALETTE STUDY / NOT FINAL VALUES

[01] [02] [03] [04]

[Color references / temperature / contrast]

TYPOGRAPHY REFERENCE

[Typeface / specimen]

[Family / source / intended character]

Keywords: [Word] / [Word] / [Word]

DECISION / [DATE]

☐ Explore ☐ Refine ☐ Park

[Chosen elements / next step]

[Decision owner]

01 Brand foundations

Translate the agreed brief into the strategic core of the brand. Replace every placeholder before release.

PURPOSE / STATEMENT PLACEHOLDER

[The reason this brand exists]

[Core promise / intended value]

MISSION / WHAT WE DO TODAY

[Who we serve / how we create value]

VISION / THE FUTURE WE SEEK

[The change we want to help create]

AUDIENCE

Who we serve

Carry forward the priority audience and core insight.

[Audience / insight]

POSITIONING

Our place in the market

State the difference, benefit and supporting proof.

[Positioning / proof]

VALUES

What guides us

Define each value as an observable behavior.

[Value / behavior]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Strategy review

Check against the signed-off brief. Note gaps or wording to refine.

[Add notes / comments]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Strategy approval / source brief link]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

02 Logo system

A home for the identity assets, their hierarchy and the right version for each context.

PRIMARY IDENTITY / ASSET PLACEHOLDER

+

[Primary logo / preferred lockup]

[Master file / version / asset link]

SECONDARY LOCKUP

+

[Alternate logo]

[Asset link / use case]

SYMBOL / AVATAR

+

[Brand symbol]

[Asset link / use case]

SINGLE-COLOR / REVERSED

+

[Reversed logo]

[Asset link / use case]

USAGE / DECISIONS

Choose the right mark

PRIMARY USE

[Preferred version / context]

VARIANT SELECTION

[When to use each alternative]

MASTER ASSETS

[Folder / SVG / PDF / PNG]

REVIEW COMMENTS

[Version / change requested]

[Approver / status / date]

03 Logo usage & clear space

Document tested limits and placement rules. Diagram geometry below is scaffolding, not a brand specification.

CLEAR SPACE / REPLACE DIAGRAM

[x = reference unit]

[Logo asset]

[Minimum surrounding space]

[Define unit / margin / exceptions]

MINIMUM-SIZE TEST

+

[Logo at tested sizes]

[Test output / viewing conditions]

DIGITAL MINIMUM

[Width in px]

PRINT MINIMUM

[Width in mm]

[Alignment / placement / background guidance]

CORRECT USAGE / TO BE DOCUMENTED

+

[Approved example]

[Why this placement works]

INCORRECT USAGE / TO BE DOCUMENTED

+

[Misuse example]

[What to avoid / why]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Usage review

Verify spacing and size at real output scale before approving these rules.

[Add notes / comments]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Tested rule / exception / approval]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

04 Color palette

Define values, roles and accessible pairings. Swatches are intentionally unassigned.

[PRIMARY ROLE]

[Set color fill]

[Color name]

HEX [#_____]

RGB [R / G / B]

CMYK [C / M / Y / K]

[Spot color / profile, if needed]

[SECONDARY ROLE]

[Set color fill]

[Color name]

HEX [#_____]

RGB [R / G / B]

CMYK [C / M / Y / K]

[Spot color / profile, if needed]

[ACCENT ROLE]

[Set color fill]

[Color name]

HEX [#_____]

RGB [R / G / B]

CMYK [C / M / Y / K]

[Spot color / profile, if needed]

[NEUTRAL ROLE]

[Set color fill]

[Color name]

HEX [#_____]

RGB [R / G / B]

CMYK [C / M / Y / K]

[Spot color / profile, if needed]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Palette review

Check digital contrast, print proofs and production profiles. Record results here.

[Add notes / comments]

USAGE & BALANCE

Give each color a job

Specify hierarchy, relative use, backgrounds and any channel-specific differences.

[Role / proportion / context]

ACCESSIBILITY / TESTED PAIRINGS

Contrast, not guesswork

[Foreground / background / contrast ratio]

[Text size / standard / pass or fail]

[Approved pairing / alternative / test link]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Approved values / pairings / test date]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

05 Typography

Specify the families, hierarchy and behavior. Sample typography is layout scaffolding only.

PRIMARY FAMILY / [NAME]

[Aa Bb Cc]

[Weights / styles / language coverage]

[Source / license / fallback]

SECONDARY FAMILY / [NAME]

[Aa Bb Cc]

[Weights / styles / language coverage]

[Source / license / fallback]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Type review

Check hierarchy, language support and readable sizes across real applications.

[Add notes / comments]

HIERARCHY / REPLACE SPECIMEN STYLES

[Headline specimen]

[Family / weight / size / line height / tracking]

[Subheading specimen]

[Family / weight / size / line height / tracking]

[Body copy specimen. Add a representative paragraph to test rhythm, legibility and line length.]

[Family / weight / size / line height / tracking]

SCALE / RESPONSIVE BEHAVIOR

[Desktop / mobile sizes / minimums]

COMPOSITION

[Alignment / line length / paragraph spacing]

SPECIAL CASES

[Captions / labels / numerals / links]

[Font files / license owner / implementation link]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Selected families / license confirmation]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

06 Imagery & art direction

Make the visual world repeatable through reference examples, intent and practical production notes.

HERO IMAGE / REFERENCE PLACEHOLDER

+

[Signature image]

[Source / license / why it fits]

COMPOSITION / CROP

+

[Framing example]

[Source / crop guidance]

LIGHT / TREATMENT

+

[Treatment example]

[Source / production notes]

SUBJECT MATTER / REPRESENTATION

[People / places / objects / inclusivity]

FRAMING / COMPOSITION

[Perspective / crop / negative space]

MOOD / LIGHT / COLOR

[Desired feeling / lighting / treatment]

SOURCING / RIGHTS / AVOID

[Source policy / consent / exclusions]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Image review

Document what to repeat or avoid.
Confirm image rights before use.

[Add notes / comments]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Art direction / rights owner / asset source]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

07 Graphic language & iconography

Define the supporting elements that make the identity a system, not just a logo.

GRAPHIC LANGUAGE / EDITABLE COMPOSITION

+

[Shape / pattern / texture system]

[Source assets / construction notes]

ICONOGRAPHY / SET PLACEHOLDERS

[ICON NAME]

+

[Icon]

[Asset link]

[ICON NAME]

+

[Icon]

[Asset link]

[ICON NAME]

+

[Icon]

[Asset link]

[ICON NAME]

+

[Icon]

[Asset link]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

System review

Test consistency, legibility at small sizes and compatibility with the logo and type.

[Add notes / comments]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Selected graphic system / icon source]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

CONSTRUCTION / GEOMETRY

[Grid / shapes / proportions / spacing]

ICON STYLE / OPTICAL RULES

[Grid / stroke / corners / fill / minimum size]

GRAPHIC BEHAVIOR

[Scale / repetition / crop / layering / limits]

[Editable master / export formats]

USAGE / ACCESSIBILITY

[Labels / contrast / alignment / do and avoid]

[Library source / license / naming convention]

08 Voice & messaging

Make the brand recognizable in words, with clear principles and real-use examples.

VOICE PRINCIPLES

How we sound

Name three principles. Describe the behavior and the boundary for each.

[Principle / we do / we do not]

CORE MESSAGE / WORKING COPY

[The one thing people should remember]

[Message pillar] / [Proof point] / [Call to action]

FEEDBACK / WORKING SPACE

Voice review

Read examples aloud. Check they feel credible to the audience and true to the strategy.

[Add notes / comments]

TONE BY SITUATION

INTRODUCE / INSPIRE

[Context / tone / example line]

EXPLAIN / SUPPORT

[Context / tone / example line]

REASSURE / RESOLVE

[Context / tone / example line]

USE / AVOID / WRITING CONVENTIONS

[On-brand headline or introduction]

[Why this language works]

[Off-brand version / rewrite]

[What to avoid / preferred alternative]

[Spelling / capitalization / terminology / inclusive language]

DECISION & FOLLOW-UP

[Voice principles / key message approval]

OWNER / DUE DATE

[Name] / [Date]

09 Applications & handoff

Show the system in context, then make it easy for the next person to use it well.

APPLICATION / DIGITAL

+

[Website / social / presentation]

[Template link / use case / editable master]

APPLICATION / PHYSICAL

+

[Print / packaging / environment]

[Template link / use case / production notes]

RELEASE CHECKLIST

Ready to hand over?

- ☐ Applications reviewed
- ☐ Final exports checked
- ☐ Fonts & rights documented
- ☐ Links & permissions tested
- ☐ Client walkthrough complete

FINAL COMMENTS / OPEN ITEMS

[Issue / owner / resolution date]

ASSET REGISTER

Files that travel with the brand

MASTER ASSETS / EXPORTS

[Folder / file list / formats / version]

TEMPLATES / GUIDELINES

[Editable templates / PDF / usage notes]

OWNERSHIP & ACCESS

A clear next step

BRAND OWNER / SUPPORT

[Name / contact / maintenance responsibility]

ACCESS / RIGHTS / UPDATES

[Permissions / licenses / change log location]

RELEASE APPROVAL

[Approver / version / date / confirmation link]